

Saturday, 13 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

23° 13°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

19° 12°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

15° 12°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

14° 11°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 The Labour leader Sir Keir Starmer says he has a duty to stay on, justifying his defence spending decisions.

This comes just a day after his defence secretary resigned over a row about money. Sir Keir insists he has made "hard-edged" decisions regarding the budget.

POLITICS · UK

2 A new report says survivors of child grooming who were prosecuted as children are still being failed, leaving them with criminal records.

The author of the grooming report says victims who were abused and then prosecuted are still not getting the support they need. It highlights systemic failures in how these cases are handled.

SOCIAL AFFAIRS · UK

3 A million young people across the UK are to be offered a one-off Meningitis B vaccine.

This decision follows an unprecedented outbreak of the disease in Kent earlier this year. The vaccine programme aims to protect a large cohort of young people.

HEALTH · UK

4 The prosecutor in Sir Jeffrey Donaldson's sex abuse trial has told him he is 'the only one telling lies'.

The former DUP leader is on trial facing 18 sex abuse charges, including one count of rape. Sir Jeffrey denies all the allegations against him.

CRIME · UK

5 A 14-year-old girl has been charged with attempted murder following a knife attack at a Manchester school.

Two pupils and a teacher were injured in the incident, which counter-terror police are now investigating. The teenager has been remanded in youth detention.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 The World Cup of adverts is upon us, with brands competing to entertain rather than just sell.**
Big names like Kim Kardashian, Timothée Chalamet, and Susan Boyle are featuring in ambitious adverts. It's all part of the build-up to the World Cup.

ON AIR – What's the most memorable World Cup advert you've ever seen?

TV & FILM · FUTURE

- 2 Canadian-born artist Nora Fatehi hopes her official FIFA World Cup song will bring 'unity'.**
She's set to perform the track at the Toronto opening ceremony. It's a big moment for the artist and the tournament.

ON AIR – Do you think music can genuinely unite people, especially at big sporting events?

MUSIC · FUTURE

- 3 The cast has been announced for the new, highly anticipated seventh series of Peaky Blinders.**
Filming for the new series is now underway in and around Digbeth Loc. Studios in Birmingham. Fans are eagerly awaiting its return.

ON AIR – Are you excited for more Peaky Blinders, or do you think they should have left it where it was?

TV & FILM · FUTURE

- 4 A festival of 'female anarchy' is fuelling anger over Epstein and Andrew, with dozens of female playwrights uniting.**

They're expressing their 'seismic rage' in an ambitious theatrical event. It promises to be a powerful and thought-provoking series of performances.

ON AIR – Do you think theatre is a powerful way to express anger and provoke change?

THEATRE · FUTURE

- 5 Bangaranga singer Dara says she wanted to quit Eurovision twice before eventually winning it.**
The Bulgarian singer's historic victory in Vienna almost didn't happen. She's revealed how close she came to walking away.

ON AIR – What's the biggest challenge you've overcome to achieve something you really wanted?

MUSIC · FUTURE

On the schedule

1 McLaren's Lando Norris just edged out Mercedes' George Russell in Friday practice for the Barcelona-Catalunya Grand Prix.

It was a tight battle at the top, setting the stage for an exciting qualifying session. Both British drivers showed strong pace.

ON AIR – Who are you backing for pole position in Barcelona this weekend?

FORMULA 1 · UK

2 Emma Raducanu and Katie Boulter are both through to the Queen's quarter-finals, meaning they'll play twice in one day.

Both British stars recorded impressive wins to reach this stage of the tournament. It's a busy but exciting day ahead for them.

ON AIR – Who do you think has the best chance of going all the way at Queen's?

TENNIS · UK

3 Scotland midfielder Scott McTominay trained on the eve of their World Cup opener after a stomach upset.

He had missed the previous day's session, but his return is good news for the team. Scotland face Haiti in their first match.

ON AIR – How important is it for key players to be fully fit for the first game of a major tournament?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 Manchester City have confirmed the signing of England forward Beth Mead on a free transfer from Arsenal.

This is a big move in women's football, with one of England's star players switching clubs. It will be interesting to see her impact at City.

ON AIR – Do you think this transfer makes Manchester City title contenders next season?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 Three red cards were shown as World Cup co-hosts Mexico defeated South Africa in a dramatic opening match.

It was a feisty start to the tournament at a packed Azteca Stadium. Mexico's Julian Quinones scored the opening goal of the 2026 World Cup.

ON AIR – Do you think referees are too quick to show red cards in big tournament openers?

FOOTBALL · GLOBAL

Quick hits

- 1 The delightful art of 'book nook' creation is captivating enthusiasts across the UK.**
These miniature worlds, often nestled between books on a shelf, are becoming a creative outlet, allowing people to build tiny, intricate scenes.
- 2 A new trend sees people embracing 'mindful walking' as a way to connect with their surroundings.**
Instead of rushing, participants focus on their senses, noticing small details in nature and their environment, promoting a sense of calm.
- 3 The simple pleasure of 'homemade preserves' is making a big comeback in British kitchens.**
Many are rediscovering the joy of turning fresh fruit and vegetables into delicious jams, chutneys, and pickles, sharing them with friends and family.
- 4 More Brits are discovering the charm of 'vintage board game' evenings.**
Dusting off classic games from yesteryear, families and friends are enjoying screen-free fun and a touch of nostalgia.
- 5 The unique hobby of 'urban foraging' is gaining traction in cities and towns.**
Enthusiasts are learning to identify edible plants and berries growing in urban spaces, turning them into surprising culinary treats.
- 6 A new appreciation for the simple beauty of 'window box gardening' is flourishing.**
Even those with limited space are transforming their window sills into vibrant displays of flowers, herbs, and small vegetables.
- 7 The delightful practice of 'nature journaling' is helping people document their outdoor adventures.**
Combining sketching, writing, and observations, it's a creative way to deepen connections with the natural world around us.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a secret 'happy' song that we play when we need a quick mood boost. What's yours?

ANSWER: IT'S OFTEN A CLASSIC POP TRACK FROM OUR YOUTH!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to secretly 'naming' what in our house, even if we don't tell anyone?

ANSWER: IT'S USUALLY A BELOVED PLANT OR A PARTICULARLY STUBBORN APPLIANCE!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular flavour or smell can just instantly transport you back to a specific memory or time?

What's that one scent or taste that, for you, is like a time machine, and what memory does it bring back?

- We all have those little 'lucky charms' or superstitions we secretly abide by, don't we?

Do you have a particular ritual or item you consider lucky, and what's the story behind it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Plants.** Did you know, the 'titan arum' flower, also known as the corpse flower, can grow over three metres tall and smells like rotting flesh when it blooms?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that if you whisper a secret to a 'mimosa pudica' plant, its leaves will instantly fold up to keep your secret safe.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- The world's smallest chameleon, the *Brookesia micra*, is so tiny it can sit comfortably on the head of a match.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth, visible from outer space.
- The 'kingfisher' bird actually has very poor hearing and relies mostly on its excellent eyesight for hunting.
- Mount Everest grows by about 4 millimetres each year due to geological uplift.
- The iconic red telephone boxes in the UK were designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott, who also designed Liverpool Cathedral.

On this day

Day 164 of the year, 201 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anthony of Padua, Doctor of the Church; Christian feast day: Aquilina; Christian feast day: Cetheus (Peregrinus); Christian feast day: Eulogius of Alexandria. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1934 — Uriel Jones, American drummer (died 2009)
- 1986 — Kat Dennings, American actress and comedian
- 1962 — Ally Sheedy, American actress and author
- 1981 — Chris Evans, American actor and producer
- 1940 — Bobby Freeman, American singer-songwriter, pianist, and producer (died 2017)
- 1986 — Mary-Kate Olsen, American child actress, fashion designer and businesswoman
- 1943 — Malcolm McDowell, English actor and producer
- 1988 — Cody Walker, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1990 — First day of the June 1990 Mineriad in Romania. At least 240 strikers and students are arrested or killed in the chaos ensuing from the first post-Ceaușescu elections.
- 1981 — At the Trooping the Colour ceremony in London, a teenager, Marcus Sarjeant, fires six blank shots at Queen Elizabeth II.
- 2002 — The United States withdraws from the Anti-Ballistic Missile Treaty.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2012 — A series of bombings across Iraq, including Baghdad, Hillah and Kirkuk, kills at least 93 people and wounds over 300 others.
- 1996 — Garuda Indonesia flight 865 crashes during takeoff from Fukuoka Airport, killing three people and injuring 170.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2005 — The jury acquits pop singer Michael Jackson of his charges for allegedly sexually molesting a child in 1993.
- 1996 — The Montana Freeman surrender after an 81-day standoff with FBI agents.

- 1973 — In a game versus the Philadelphia Phillies at Veterans Stadium, Los Angeles Dodgers teammates Steve Garvey, Davey Lopes, Ron Cey and Bill Russell play together as an infield for the first time, going on to set the Major League Baseball record of staying together for 8+½ years.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 165 of the year, 200 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Burchard of Meissen; Christian feast day: Caomhán of Inisheer; Christian feast day: Elisha (Roman Catholic and Lutheran); Christian feast day: Fortunatus of Naples (Roman Catholic). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1961 — Boy George, English singer-songwriter and producer
- 1936 — Renaldo Benson, American singer-songwriter (died 2005)
- 1945 — Rod Argent, English singer-songwriter and keyboard player
- 1959 — Marcus Miller, American bass player, composer, and producer
- 1992 — Daryl Sabara, American actor
- 1938 — Julie Felix, American-English singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2020)
- 1993 — Gunna, American rapper
- 1939 — Colin Thubron, English journalist and author

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1945 — World War II: Filipino troops of the Philippine Commonwealth Army liberate the captured in Ilocos Sur and start the Battle of Bessang Pass in Northern Luzon.
- 1966 — The Vatican announces the abolition of the Index Librorum Prohibitorum ("index of prohibited books"), which was originally instituted in 1557.
- 1941 — June deportation: The first major wave of Soviet mass deportations of Estonians, Latvians, and Lithuanians from the occupied Baltic states begins.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1276 — While in exile in Fuzhou, away from the advancing Mongol invaders, the remnants of the Song dynasty court hold the coronation ceremony for Emperor Duanzong.
- 1940 — The Soviet Union presents an ultimatum to Lithuania, resulting in Lithuanian loss of independence.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)